

Humber College Innovation Challenge 2025

Building Real Solutions for Real Student Life

A brief note from Lev:

Hi there!

I took a lot of time thinking about what would make the most sense for you to focus on when designing and developing your next big idea for this design sprint.

I want this project to serve three primary functions for you:

- 1. Become something that you use for yourself*
- 2. Become a standout portfolio piece*
- 3. Become a potential business venture*

But where to start?

I suggest trying to solve a problem you've personally experienced. This way, you can put yourself in the shoes of your future customer and design a useful, innovative, and engaging solution! Use the below 10 problem spaces as a starting point for your project!

You're also welcome to pitch your own ideas to me (but no promises it will be approved.) I hope you enjoy this challenge! Good luck and have fun 💪

The Challenge

Choose ONE of the below ten real student problems and create an innovative solution that combines technology with business viability.

Your goal is to build something you and your peers would actually use, and that could scale into a viable business.



Problem Spaces

Project #1: Campus Space Finder

Problem: Students waste time searching for available study spaces, labs, and resources

Current pain points:

- No real-time availability information
- Popular spaces are often full
- Quiet spaces become noisy
- Group study rooms are poorly managed

Opportunity areas:

- Real-time occupancy tracking
- Space reservation systems
- Noise level monitoring
- Resource management

Project #2: Academic Resource Network

Problem: Study materials are scattered across platforms and hard to verify

Current pain points:

- Unreliable study guides
- Scattered class notes
- Lost past exams
- Unverified materials

Opportunity areas:

Content verification
Collaborative note-taking
Resource marketplace
Knowledge organization

Project #3: Student Skill Marketplace

Problem: Students can't easily monetize their skills or find peer help

Current pain points:

- Hard to find verified tutors
- Payment handling is awkward
- Scheduling is difficult
- Skill verification is lacking

Opportunity areas:

- Peer-to-peer learning
- Micro-consulting
- Skill verification
- Payment system

Project #4: Group Project Manager

Problem: Group projects are inefficient and often unfair

Current pain points:

- Uneven workload distribution
- Poor coordination
- Unclear contributions
- Schedule conflicts

Opportunity areas:

- Contribution tracking
- Task management
- Meeting optimization
- Fair evaluation

Project #5: Course Compass

Problem: Course selection is stressful and often based on limited information

Current pain points:

- Unclear course content
- Unknown professor styles
- Career impact uncertainty
- Prerequisite planning

Opportunity areas:

- Course recommendations
- Career alignment
- Peer reviews
- Academic planning

Project #6: Student Life Balancer

Problem: Managing academics, social life, and health is overwhelming

Current pain points:

- Time management
- Health maintenance
- Social coordination
- Work-life balance

Opportunity areas:

- Schedule optimization
- Wellness tracking
- Social planning
- Priority management

Project #7: Campus Food Optimizer

Problem: Campus dining is expensive, time-consuming, and often unhealthy

Current pain points:

- Long wait times
- Limited healthy options
- Budget management
- Dietary restrictions

Opportunity areas:

- Wait time prediction
- Meal planning
- Group ordering
- Dietary tracking

Project #8: Social Connection Hub

Problem: Finding and connecting with like-minded peers is difficult

Current pain points:

- Club discovery
- Event awareness
- Interest matching
- Schedule coordination

Opportunity areas:

- Interest-based matching
- Event planning
- Group coordination
- Social discovery

Project #9: Student Budget Navigator

Problem: Managing student finances and finding deals is complex

Current pain points:

- Expense tracking
- Deal finding
- Budget planning
- Financial education

Opportunity areas:

- Expense automation
- Deal aggregation
- Budget optimization
- Financial planning

Project #10: Campus Safety Network

Problem: Students often feel unsafe or unsupported on campus

Current pain points:

- Late-night safety
- Emergency response
- Resource awareness
- Community support

Opportunity areas:

- Safety monitoring
- Community alerts
- Resource connection
- Support networks

Project #11: Pitch Your Own!

If you'd like to propose your own idea you must include the following information:

1. One-liner problem statement
2. Current pain points (at least 4 points)
3. Opportunity areas (at least 4 points)

Send this information to my email (lev.markelov@humber.ca). Please, include ALL group member names and student ID's. Also notify me in class. Keep in mind, not every idea will be approved. Let's see what you can come up with!



Solution Requirements

Your solution must include:

Technical Components (Choose at least 3)

- ☐ Mobile application
- ☐ Web platform
- ☐ IoT integration
- ☐ AI/ML implementation
- ☐ AR features
- ☐ Real-time data processing
- ☐ Payment systems
- ☐ Social features

Business Elements (Choose at least 2)

- ☐ Clear revenue model
- ☐ Market analysis
- ☐ Growth strategy
- ☐ Partnership opportunities

User Experience (All required)

- User research
- Experience design
- Interface design
- User testing
- Feedback systems



Loose Development Process

Phase 1: Research & Planning (Weeks 1-3)

- Problem validation
- User research
- Market analysis
- Technical planning
- Business model development

Phase 2: Design & Prototyping (Weeks 4-6)

- UX/UI design
- Technical architecture
- Prototype development
- User testing
- Business validation

Phase 3: Development (Weeks 7-10)

- Core feature development
- Integration
- Testing
- User feedback
- Performance optimization

Phase 4: Launch Preparation (Weeks 11-13)

- Final testing
- Documentation
- Marketing preparation
- Pitch development
- Growth planning

Final Deliverables

1. Working MVP

- Core features
- User interface
- Technical documentation
- Testing results

2. Business Plan

- Market analysis
- Revenue model
- Growth strategy
- Financial projections

3. Presentation Package

- Pitch deck
- Demo video
- Marketing materials
- Growth roadmap

Good luck and...

Remember...!

The best solutions will come from your own experience and understanding of these problems. Focus on building something you would actually use and that solves a real pain point in your daily student life.